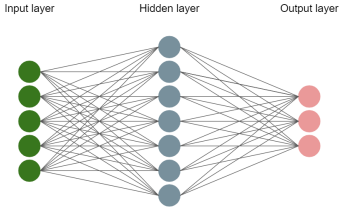
Introduction to Machine Learning

ML-Basics
Models & Parameters



Learning goals

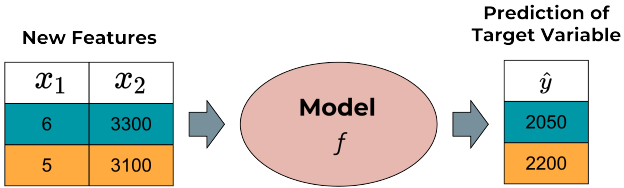
- Understand that an ML model is simply a parametrized function
- Understand that the hypothesis space lists all admissible models
- Understand relationship between hypothesis and parameter space

WHAT IS A MODEL?

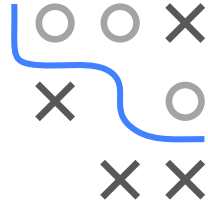
- A **model** (or **hypothesis**)

$$f : \mathcal{X} \to \mathbb{R}^g$$

  is a function that maps feature vectors to predicted target values.
- In regression: $g = 1$; in classification, g is the number of classes, and output vectors are scores or class probabilities.



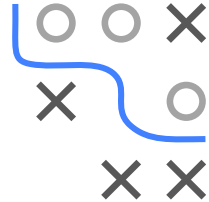
HYPOTHESIS SPACES



- Without restrictions on the functional family, the task of finding a "good" model among all available models is impossible to solve.
- We have to determine the class of our model *a priori*, thereby narrowing down the search space. We call this a **structural prior**.
- The set of functions defining a specific model class is called a **hypothesis space** $\mathcal{H}$:

$$\mathcal{H} = \{f : f \text{ belongs to a certain functional family}\}$$

PARAMETRIZATION

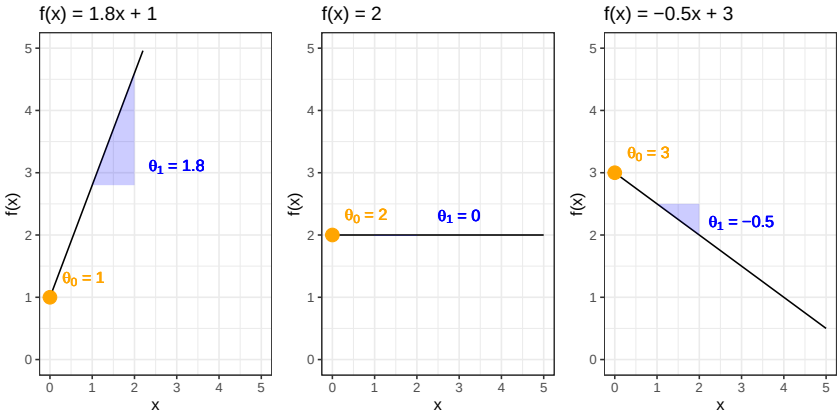


- All models within a hypothesis space share a common functional structure. We usually construct the space as **parametrized family of functions**.
- We collect all parameters in a **parameter vector** $\boldsymbol{\theta} = (\theta_1, \theta_2, \ldots, \theta_d)$ from **parameter space** Θ.
- They are our means of fixing a specific function from the family. Once set, our model is fully determined.
- Therefore, we can re-write $\mathcal{H}$ as:

$$\mathcal{H} = \{f_{\boldsymbol{\theta}} : \quad f_{\boldsymbol{\theta}} \text{ belongs to a certain functional family parameterized by } \boldsymbol{\theta}\}$$

EXAMPLE: UNIVARIATE LINEAR FUNCTIONS

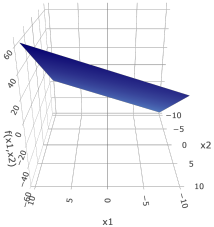
$$\mathcal{H} = \{f : f(\mathbf{x}) = \theta_0 + \theta_1 x, \boldsymbol{\theta} \in \mathbb{R}^2\}$$



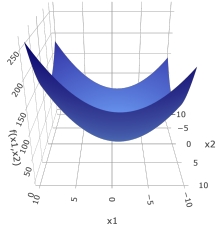
EXAMPLE: BIVARIATE QUADRATIC FUNCTIONS

$$\mathcal{H} = \{f : f(\mathbf{x}) = \theta_0 + \theta_1 x_1 + \theta_2 x_2 + \theta_3 x_1^2 + \theta_4 x_2^2 + \theta_5 x_1 x_2, \boldsymbol{\theta} \in \mathbb{R}^6\},$$

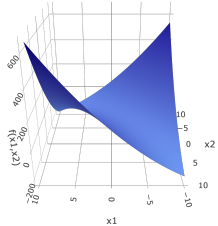
$f(x) = 3 + 2x_1 + 4x_2$



$f(x) = 3 + 2x_1 + 4x_2 +$
$+ 1x_1^2 + 1x_2^2$



$f(x) = 3 + 2x_1 + 4x_2 +$
$+ 1x_1^2 + 1x_2^2 + 4x_1 x_2$



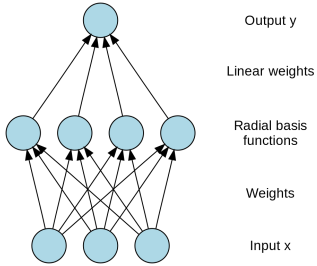
EXAMPLE: RBF NETWORK

Radial basis function networks with Gaussian basis functions

$$\mathcal{H} = \left\{ f : f(\mathbf{x}) = \sum_{i=1}^{k} a_i \rho(\|\mathbf{x} - \mathbf{c}_i\|) \right\},$$

where

- a_i is the weight of the i-th neuron,
- $\mathbf{c}_i$ its center vector, and
- $\rho(\|\mathbf{x} - \mathbf{c}_i\|) = \exp(-\beta\|\mathbf{x} - \mathbf{c}_i\|^2)$ is the i-th radial basis function with bandwidth $\beta \in \mathbb{R}$.



Usually, the number of centers k and the bandwidth β need to be set in advance (so-called *hyperparameters*).